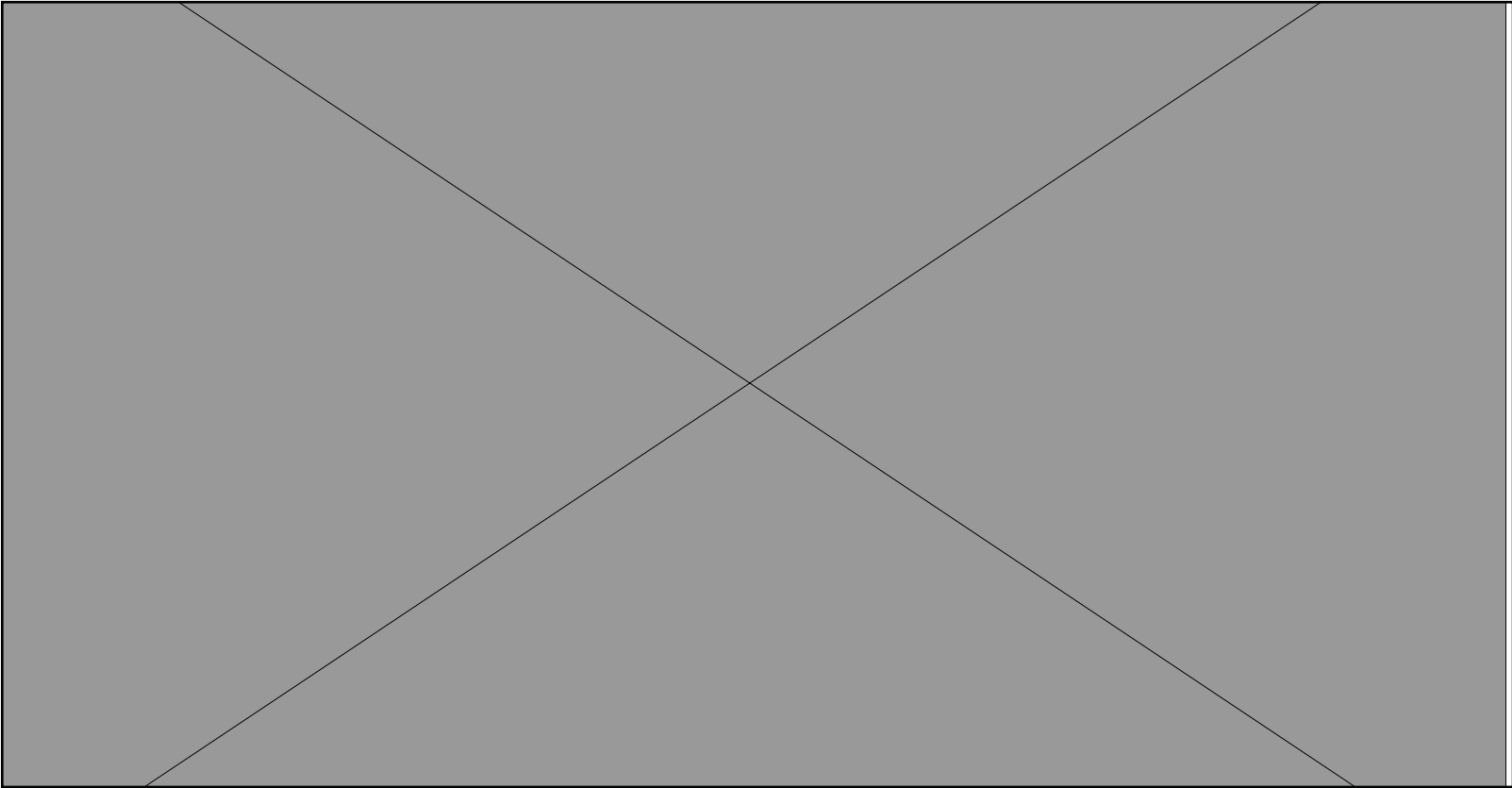




Hi Daniel Plz Deliver this Time



Caption caption

by DANIEL PEKAR

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See **STRESS** on **P5**

HOSA

by MARZAN HAMID

This year, HOSA Canada (Health Occupations Students of America) held their second annual Spring Leadership Conference on 3 March to 4 March at the Hilton Hotel and the University of Toronto Exam Centre. HOSA Canada is still in a developmental stage, and will continue to expand over the next few years. Approximately 1,100 ambitious and hopeful students from all across Canada were in attendance, making the streets of the financial district ridden with high school students in business-formal clothing. “I’m really excited for this year’s HOSA,” said Hanlin Cheng, a Grade 9 student who participated in the ‘Biomedical Debate’ event.

See **HOSA** on **P3**

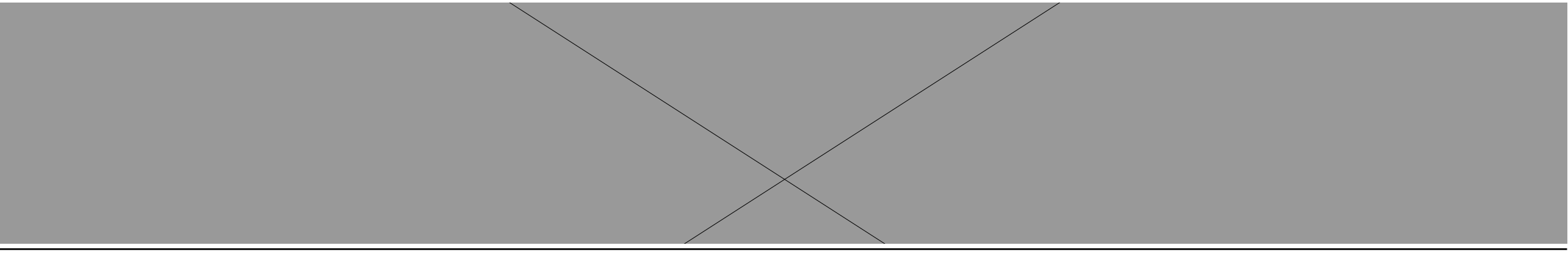
New 2nd Semester SAC Members Sworn In

by JULIE XIAO

On Tuesday, 8 March, the Student Activity Council (SAC) ushered in 5 new members in the team. SAC added four semester members and a new Spirit Convener. As semester representatives, their tasks are to help the six non-semester leaders with upcoming projects and events, increase productivity, and spread more outreach about SAC activities.

The new members of SAC are listed below.
 Grade 9 Rep- Saima Zafar
 Grade 10 Rep- Lisa Wang
 Grade 11 Rep- Fariha Haleem
 Grade 12 Rep- Fatima Ghummen
 Spirit Convener- Arani Kulamurugan ■

Online announcements!



Clubs Feature: Youth Against Drugs (YAD)

by VARUN VENKATARAMANAN

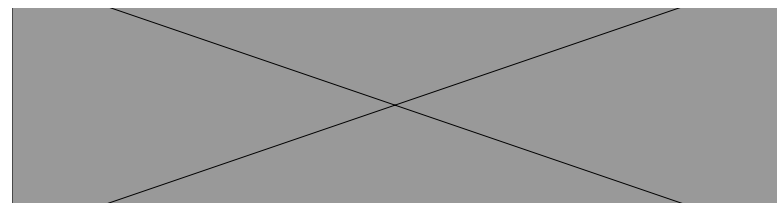
Youth Against Drugs (YAD), is a group of dedicated students that want to raise awareness about the effects of drugs and substance abuse. With substance abuse a known issue in the school community, members aim to inform and educate fellow Garneau students about drugs they might encounter so that they may make conscious decisions in the future. YAD meets every Monday at lunch in Room 235, for student presentations and discussions on various drugs and their effects.

While having been a club for 3 years, YAD ran into a major setback this year: they lost their teacher advisor and had to find a new one. The club's president, Michael Ng, was away for a period of time in September, but as soon as he came back, he put up announcements in department offices and asked many teachers, but unfortunately to no avail. The club was unable to meet for first semester. Luckily, Ms. Woodley agreed to supervise them at the beginning of second semester, and the club hasn't looked back since.

A typical meeting involves an in-depth presentation on a specific drug by a club executive (or a regular member if they request so). A presentation covers what the drug is, its effects/symptoms, addictiveness, and legality among many other things. These presentations are very open, with lots of time for questions and open discussion.

YAD looks forward to running many events through the remainder of this year, most notably the Fatal Vision Challenge which has been a success in years past. Taking place in the gym, the challenge is run by YAD in partnership with Toronto Public Health. Students partake in various games and activities that educate them about the effects of illicit substances. One such activity involves a student wearing goggles that simulate the vision of a drunk individual. They then try to accomplish a task such as driving a small buggie around the gym while impaired. YAD also plans to organize talks and presentations from guest speakers.

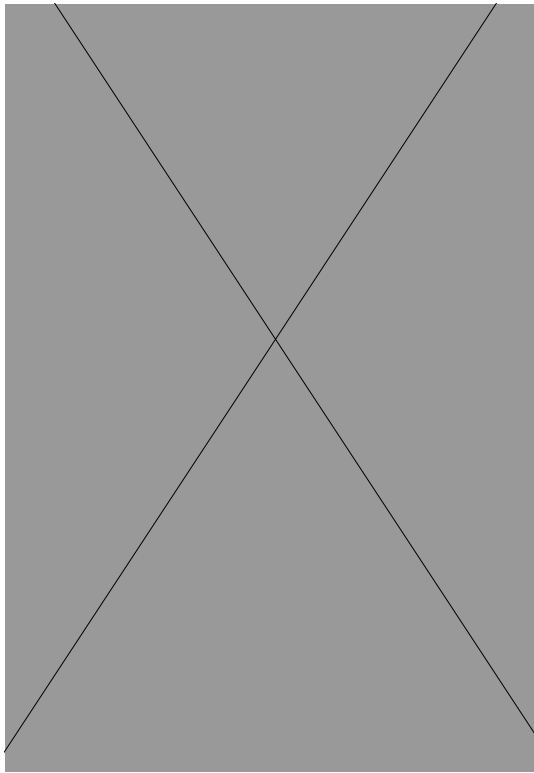
Youth Against Drugs is a fun yet sincere club that tackles the serious problem of substance abuse amongst teens. Member Zi Yu Cai says, "It's an amazing club." He recommends the club to anyone interested in joining.



Mr. Lawrence

by RUSSELL IJAYA

Mr. Lawrence is the head of the English department and an English teacher at MGCI.



Mr. Lawrence. Photo: Matthew Tse

Q: Have you always aspired to be an educator?

A: Not always, when I was in high school I wanted to be a doctor. I think my second choice was to be a dentist. Thirdly, a nurse. At the time, the thing of the day was male nurses, which was widely discussed. During career week, they took students who were interested in the medical field to the hospital. Right when we got to the gate, I started to feel nauseous, I started to feel ill, I thought, "you know what? Maybe this isn't for me". As a default, I went into teaching. I knew I wanted to be a professional, but I wasn't sure in what field. During exam seasons, I became the leader of study groups, and based on the responses of my peers, it was one of my strengths. As a result, I tried out for teacher's college and got in at a very young age, perhaps too young. But from there on out, I embarked on my teaching journey and I have no regrets.

Q: What's your favorite part about being a teacher?

A: My favorite part about being a teacher is just to see students become more enlightened, to grow, to bloom, to blossom. Really, it's helping them discover talents and traits that they never knew about themselves before. I'm the tool they can use to really unlock their potential. Being a teacher is a very humbling and imploring as I watch students grow and mature.

Q: Any other passions asides from teaching?

A: As a matter of fact, it's acting. Living in Jamaica, I was a well-known stage actor and I also did quite a bit of voice-overs in commercials, people said I had a great reader voice. While I was not teaching at night, I was performing in comedies, dramas, musicals. I was in a few Broadway-script musicals. When I was in New York, I did a few off-Broadway productions and television commercials. Once I came to Canada, I directed a few plays and acted in some as well. However, I haven't done anything recently, being the head department of

English came with a load of other responsibilities, in addition to my three grade 11 classes. Though this passion has been on hold for the past 2 or 3 years, it still is one of my greatest pleasures.

Q: What philosophy could you give to any student at MGCI?

A: (Deep in thought) Well, I have quite a few but first of all, surround yourself with positive people. They will motivate you, inspire you and see the good in you. When they see that good, the positive energy allows you to take off and soar like an eagle. Secondly, believing in yourself goes together. If you only have one but not the other, the two forces will go against each other. I strongly believe as humans we are spiritual beings, whether we choose to be religious or not. I truly believe that we feed off the energy of others. I tell students it doesn't matter where you come from, we have the power to change our circumstances. Even though it's easier said than done, we just have to start by believing in it. This will be a game changer in our lives, which we can also use to positively affect the lives of others.

Q: As the head of the English department, do you consider it to be the most important of all the subjects?

A: I don't want to call it a subject, but I know what you mean. But yes, I do believe it to be very important nowadays, as the standard of communication is quite low. I believe this is due to the excessive usage of social media and technology. I'd say many people – not most are addicted to its usage. Yes, addicted to the use of social media. Some people can't see themselves not holding a phone and going onto their Facebook, twitter, chatter, etc. Therefore, most of people's reading is on social media – adults and young people alike. When it comes to formal writing and communications, people's skills have definitely taken a nosedive.

Q: You seem to have a lot of opinions on humanity, what is your major concern for our species?

A: Our ignorance. I say that because we think we are more enlightened today, with the advent of our technology and great innovations –even the cell phone which is a rather new device. Yet we are still very ignorant, there's all this hurt, pain, war and discord in the world. Whether it's between the states and the middle east, North Korea, South Korea. Why is it we have not found solutions to all these grave problems? Whether it's world hunger or war, humans pride themselves on being the most intelligent species, but since the beginning of time, we struggle to find solutions. We are still grappling with our many major problems, like racism. I can never understand how people are still racist. My mind is always trying to find answers. In my Grade 11 university-level English classes, I get my students to not just give me a beautiful written response, but to come up with solutions to the problems that we see in short stories, Shakespeare, Macbeth, etc. How can we come up with new resolutions to solve problems? It's not just good enough to come up with a problem, to simply state facts about the paragraphs. That's what I'm interested in, what I push my students in is to come up with solutions, not just figure out what the problem is.

Q: Any last facts you think students should know about you?

A: I love dancing and acting crazy- I know how to have a good time. Though people think I have a very stern personality – yes I know I'm tall and have a booming voice, but if a student comes to me individually, I'm extremely personable, warm and amicable. I also see you as an individual, when you come to me I will see you as the most important person in the world to me. That is a standard I hold, if I'm talking to you face to face, I will try to give off the aura that you are important – so no one feels inferior, instead they feel accepted and valued. Hopefully when people perceive this, they can mirror this attitude towards others.

MGCI's 2016 Curling Season

by CHENG CHENG LIN

On 8 March 2016, three of four Marc Garneau C.I. curling teams played their playoff games at Tam Heather Curling and Tennis Club: Girl's Tier 2 A, Girl's Tier 2 B, and Boy's Tier 2. All three teams, and the Boy's Tier 1 team of Marc Garneau, were coached by Ms. Wiltenburg.

The Girl's A team, who had placed third in the overall season, faced Victoria Park Collegiate Institute's curling team, the second place team. The team lost to Victoria Park C.I. with a score of 5-6.

The Girl's B team, having placed first in the overall season, faced Albert Campbell Collegiate Institute, the fourth place team. They won their semi-final match with a score of 5-4, and will be moving onto the finals match on 24 March 2016, after the March Break.

"I think we've been very fortunate so far, and hopefully we can continue succeeding," says Caryn Qian, the skip on the Girl's B team, "I think it was a very lucky season, and it was a cool thing to try out."

The Girl's B team completely consisted of players in Grade 9, so this season was their first attempt at curling. The Girl's A team had five players who were curling for the first time this season, and one player that was a veteran.

that would allow them to qualify for OFSAA. The team lost with a score of 5-7 against Richview Collegiate Institute at the Bayview Golf and Country Club.

When asked about the overall season, Ryan Lin, the vice skip—or, as he would like to be called, the "vice captain"—of the Boy's Tier 1 team said, "It was very enjoyable playing with everyone on the team again this year."

The overall season for the Tier 2 teams ended with their last non-playoff game on 1 March 2016.

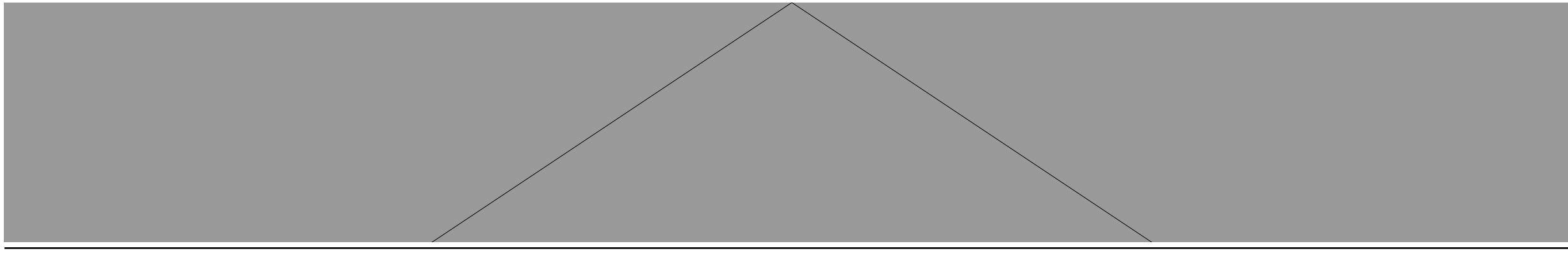
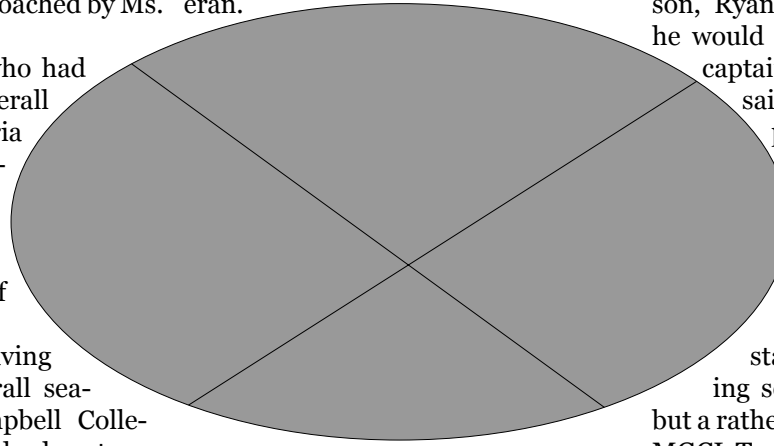
Concluding a league that started in December, the curling season is longer than most, but a rather small community. All four MGCI Teams played the majority of their games at either the Tam Heather Curling and Tennis Club in Scarborough, or the Bayview Glen Golf and Country Club in Markham.

The team has seen a significant increase in members from the previous school year to this one, and, without any Grade 12 members who will be graduating, the team looks forward to next year's season.

The Boy's Tier 2 team faced John A. MacDonald Collegiate Institute, the second place team in their league, and lost with a score of 4-11.

The Boy's Tier 2 and Girl's A team will be finishing their season off with a third place match on 24 March 2016.

Finally, the MGCI's Boy's Tier 1 team played their final match on 26 Feb 2016, a city championship match



Upgrades to MGCI

by Deifilia To

Since the beginning of the 2015-2016 school year, there have been substantial changes to the physical structures within the school. Each department is allocated a certain amount of money to spend on school resources, and, if necessary, are encouraged to make big-ticket purchases before the end of each school year. However, if there is money left over from one year, teachers are allowed to roll over the remaining money to spend in the following year.

Using money that was rolled over from the 2014-2015 school year, MGCI has made five major investments this year.

1. Bleachers: These bleachers had been previously broken. New bleachers were put up on the week of 29 February – 4 March.

2. Increased number of surveillance cameras

3. Retiling the office

4. Updating Wi-Fi networks in the school

5. Blinds in classrooms: To create a more optimal learning environment, every classroom will be equipped with blinds. This was scheduled to be done over the March Break.

While there have been significant improvements to the infrastructure of the school, there are still several needs that are currently being addressed. For one, the school has been looking at purchasing a high-pixel digital sign to place outside. It would need to be large enough for drivers to read as they pass by the building. In order to accommodate for foreign languages, the resolution on the sign needs to be higher than the standard. At this point in time, Canada does not sell any signs that are both large enough and have an adequately high pixel density. A potential solution is to synchronize four outdoor televisions to display information. While this is not the optimal design, it is rather feasible solution. Recently, there have been many complaints regarding the network of the school system. (In fact, Garneau is ranked first in the school board for the number of calls to IT they make. Keep in mind, however, that multiple teachers in individual departments may call for help in any given network crash.) Primary concerns around our network are around the fact that students cannot log on to their school accounts, or the Wi-Fi network, and that Wi-Fi is often slow. Given the number of calls they received after the entire school's network system stopped functioning, the TDSB took special interest in the school, sending staff from IT to investigate. They went through the school labs, checking on the quality available. Over the March Break, staff from the IT department checked the physical structure of the network to determine the root cause of the issue. Students can expect improvements in the network over the next few weeks.

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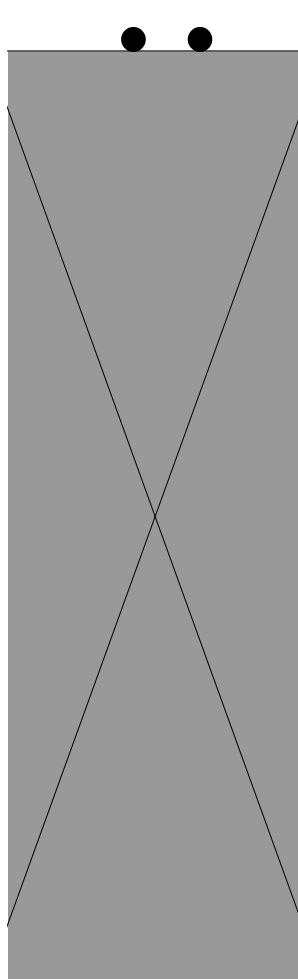


Photo: Cindy Cui

MR. JAY

by FIRSTNAME LASTNAME

Mr. Jay is the assistant curriculum leader and teacher of computer science at Marc Garneau.

Q: How long have you been teaching at Garneau?

A: This is my 26th year.

Q: What courses are you teaching this year?

A: Computer Science Grade 12, Grade 10 TOPS Computer

Science last semester, Grade 12 Robotics, and Grade 10 (Computer) Engineering.

Q: How did you first get into computer science and programming?

A: I took Computer Science in Grade 10, 11, and 12, back in the early 80s. In Grade 10 we had five Commodore PET computers in our lab and pencil marked cards, so the first programs I ever wrote were on pencil marked cards. You had to make a stack of them and then they would get shipped off somewhere to be read, and would come back with a printout of your code and whatever your output was. Then you would just fix the pencil marked cards, and send it back the next day. That was my first course.

In Grade 11 and 12, we had a full lab of Commodore PETs, 8K of RAM, 16K of RAM, no hard drive but a floppy drive, and we could make great things with that, the graphics were chunky but you could still do pretty amazing things.

When I went to university, I didn't go for Computer Science. I was in Actuarial Science and then I switched to Statistics, so Computer Science was just my second teachable. I always thought I would be a math teacher, but I got hired for this job and I've done math over the years, but for the most part I've been teaching Computer Science.

Q: Did you do anything else before becoming a teacher?

A: No. I like to tell kids that I'm in 'Grade 43', because I've been in school continuously since I was 5 years old.

Q: What is your most memorable experience with computers? Any favourite projects or programs you have done in the past?

A: Early on when I was experimenting with graphics, I made myself a Spiderman game. So I just imported graphics, had Spiderman walking or running, climbing walls, spinning webs, swinging, and I'd bring in different villains for him to fight, where you would hit space bar and a new villain would come in and attack him. It was never a complete game, I've never been a gamer, but just the idea of doing that was always fun for me, and I think when you're learning how to program, it's nice to have the motivation of a project you want to do, something you want to create, and then you go through and learn the things you need to make that happen. That's probably the best way to learn.

Q: Computer science is a tricky course to teach, do you have any specific philosophies or lesson approaches?

A: I like to throw you into the deep end first, get you into it right away, and not give you every little bit and piece, so just kind of the "broad-strokes" start. Let you play around a little bit see what works and doesn't work, then sort of pull you

back and talk more about the details after that. But as far as learning Computer Science goes, I think the most important thing is, probably like any other course, you have to actually be able to do it on your own. When I am helping someone who is having trouble with Computer Science, I would show them how to do it first, and then I would get them to reproduce the effect with another question and some help, just like I would do in math. And then they do it again without any help. Until they can do it without help, they're not done, they're not ready to move onto the next stage; that's kind of my philosophy for extra help. Because a lot of people will get it right away and a lot will struggle with it, but that is what I would say is my philosophy.

Q: In your opinion, what makes a successful programmer?

A: As a student, if you have passion for it, if you have interest in it, then you will probably dedicate more time to it; you would look stuff up more, be less dependent on your teacher, less dependent on your friends, less dependent on the book. If you just try things and fail... I tell my daughter all the time that the best way to learn is to make mistakes, but she doesn't accept that and she wants to be perfect all the time...but that's just not going to happen. I think having a passion for it really makes a difference.

Q: Any favourite computer jokes?

A: I don't tell jokes, I make cracks. I don't have a list of jokes that I tell, I don't have them rehearsed. I had a Biology teacher in high school that was hilarious the first time I had him, he had all these very funny jokes, then I had him again in Grade 13 and he told the same jokes. He had his own routine, but I don't, I just made my cracks during class.

Q: Would you rather: Master every programming language or become fluent in every spoken language?

A: Spoken, for sure. Once you've learned one (programming language) well, learning a new one isn't that hard. For example, if you know Java then you pretty much know C, you just have to learn a few little bits on input and output and some of the specialized libraries. It's like if you know Italian, learning Spanish is not that hard because the Romantic languages, French, Italian, Spanish, Portuguese, they're all kind of related. But I mean, how are you going to go learn Mandarin or Russian? Knowing all the spoken languages, that would be awesome.

Q: Any advice for aspiring programmers or students in general?

A: Take lots of courses so I stay employed (laughs), not like it matters that much now.

I guess my advice is to do things on your own, on the side. There are some kids who don't do programming in their spare time and still get good marks, but most of the people who are really successful do it in their spare time. It's a fun thing for them. So rather than just playing video games you can make video games, maybe making android or iOS apps as a hobby.

Satire : A Critical Look at Charlie Hebdo

by KHALIDA ELSADATI

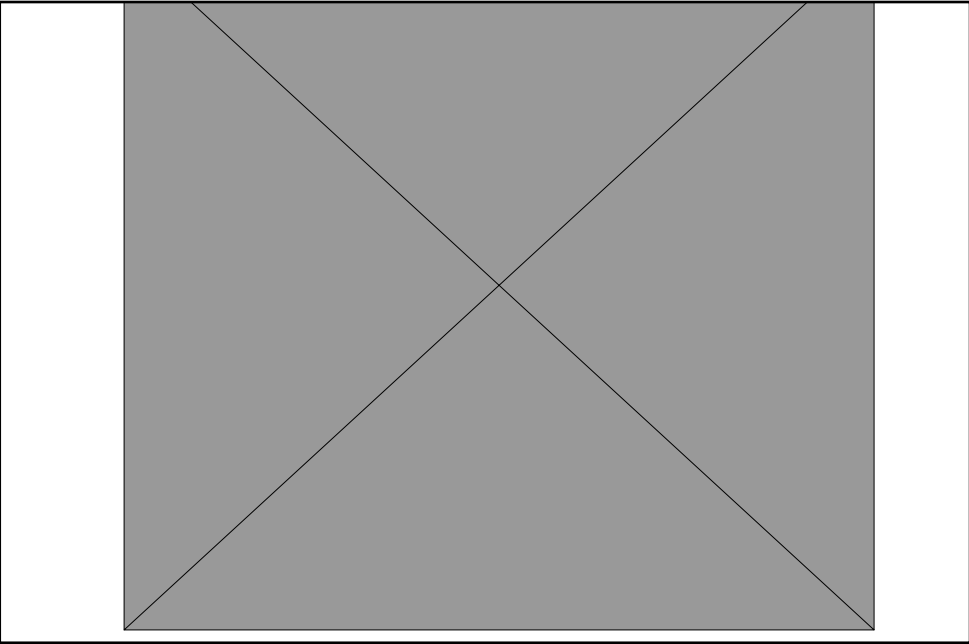


Illustration: Lila Huang

The French satirical newspaper, Charlie Hebdo, recently went under fire for publishing a cartoon comic in yet another display of pure indecency. Commenting on the recent stories of Muslim refugees allegedly assaulting women throughout Europe, the comic depicted two ape-like men chasing women through the street with a caption translating into “What would little Aylan Kurdi have grown up to be? Ass groper in Germany.”

Aylan Kurdi was the young boy photographed after washing up dead on the shore of a Turkish beach earlier this year. The image horrified the world, not only inspiring rallies and fundraisers for the Syrian Refugees, but also causing many Westerners, who had previously been sheltered from the true severity of the conflicts within Syria, to face their international social responsibilities.

It’s not the first time that Charlie Hebdo has gotten itself into trouble as a result of its controversial content. In January 2015, the newspaper staff were victim to violent attacks instigated by insensitive comics. Ever since, Charlie Hebdo has been testing its limitations. Its particular brand of comedy is fairly unique to France and uses brutal satire to ridicule hypocrisy within Europe. It seeks to critique French prejudices through political cartoons and cheeky humor. In response to the Kurdi controversy, many of Charlie Hebdo’s readers were quick to argue that the comic was not intentionally offensive, but was rather critiquing Europe’s hidden biases against incoming refugees. The image, though crass and callous, was meant to mock many conservative French ideologies and encourage Europeans to reevaluate their prejudices.

Though the image might have been interpreted as such, Charlie Hebdo’s sudden concern for refugees is rather convenient. The issue of discrimination towards Syrian refugees in Europe is one of great urgency, but Charlie Hebdo

should have chosen a different image to depict this. Satirical newspapers are not new to literature and text is constantly being released around the globe which comedices political and social philosophies. There is no issue with using comedy to discuss topics, but there is a difference between satire ridiculing hypocrisy and the current imagery being used in Charlie Hebdo’s publications.

Charlie Hebdo is not sharing an edgy, new perspective on an ongoing issue; rather, it is capitalizing on the death of a child. The newspaper’s intent was to attract a wider viewership, but this goal was achieved in a troublesome manner. Rather than being analytical, the cartoonists used controversial imagery to attract viewers to their newspaper and then wrote it off as a witty comic piece. It should not be necessary for the reader to have a deep understanding of French and European culture in order to understand the comic’s humour. Accordingly, it is crucial that news workers are aware of the social implications involved with publishing their pieces.

In the last few years, Charlie Hedbo has become notorious for its lack of eloquence in the face of controversy. The discussion on the limitations of satirical news is one we have had at great length. It is time to recognize that although comedy can be controversial, it should not further disadvantage marginalized minorities. People have the right to do, say, and draw whatever they want, but they must also be willing to deal with the resulting criticism. By dismissing those who condemn Charlie Hebdo, we are only silencing voices that are already struggling to be heard. With all the technology available to us today, it is easy to forget that there are still many people having trouble reaching out and voicing their opinions. They are being spoken over. In order to continue the discussion,

The CRISPR Debate: Lawrence Pang vs. Khari Thomas

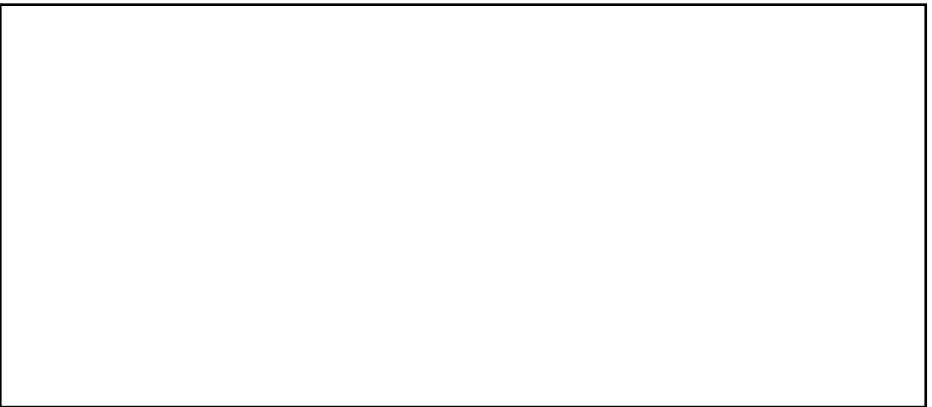


Illustration: Someone Someone

CRISPR (Clustered Regularly Interspaced Short Palindromic Repeats) is a new genetic engineering technique which allows scientists to edit the DNA of almost any living thing. It is becoming increasingly popular throughout the scientific world due to its simple mechanisms and relatively low cost. This has allowed scientists to perform more experiments involving DNA modification, including the exciting, albeit controversial, usage of gene therapy. Scientists hope that CRISPR can be used to cure various genetic diseases, such as sickle-cell anemia, or to repair genes which may cause cancer or other defects.

While gene therapy does have potential in curing disease, some are concerned about the use of this technology beyond medical applications. In particular, the ability to manipulate genes may lead to “designer babies”: parents being able to select certain genetic traits for their children, whether in terms of appearance, physique, intelligence, or other fields. Furthermore, the use of gene therapy may lead to a slippery slope effect, whereby genetic manipulation may be used maliciously, e.g. to create super soldiers.

Pro- (Lawrence)

If you’ve read a few too many dystopian novels, you might immediately jump to the conclusion that governments will use this technology maliciously - e.g. creating super-soldiers. But this is not a realistic threat for today’s military technology. What chance would any human being, no matter their genetic material, stand against a tank or a bomb? The reality is that genetics can only do so much. You’ll never find a gene that lets you shoot lasers out of your eyes or grow a machine gun for an arm. And in the same vein, rich people might choose to give their children extreme intelligence, but if they can’t apply it or lack other life skills the benefits are minimal.

The other (more realistic) argument against “designer babies” is that it will increase inequality - only rich people will be able to afford this technology, so their children will be successively better off. But this is not as much of an issue as one might think. For starters, it’s not as if the rich aren’t giving their children an advantage already. For every self-made billionaire like Bill Gates, there are a dozen John Rockefeller IIIs who inherited the majority of their wealth.

Furthermore, every major technological leap increases inequality: agriculture, for instance, which created an upper class of landowners, or the industrial revolution, which fueled the rise of Western nations. And yet, without these advances, we would still be living in caves. What people fail to realize is that although genetic modification technology might make the rich richer, it will also make the poor richer—they’ll have greater protection against disease and genetic disorders, and positive genetic traits will eventually spread across society.

Now, it is true that CRISPR is very much still in development. In its current form, it is not ready for use on human beings. However, every technology takes time and resources to develop, and banning CRISPR out of paranoia is not going to help. Rather than eliminating any incentive for researchers to work on this promising gene therapy technology, we should encourage and actively search for ways we can use it to benefit humanity.

The truth is that many fear genetic modification technology not for rational reasons, but due to gut instinct—an emotional response against things perceived as “unnatural” or “playing god.” But this is no longer an acceptable attitude today, when people around the world live better lives than ever before because of developments such as electricity, surgery, and vaccination, all of which are very much unnatural. Those who are uncomfortable with the idea of genetic modification are free to abstain from it—but they have no right to deny others from doing the best for their

Opposition - (Khari)

CRISPR has many potential benefits, such as curing certain genetically-influenced diseases. However, there are more controversial uses for it, one being the development of “designer babies” which can be genetically altered in order to give them favoured traits. Alongside the serious safety concerns regarding the usage of CRISPR in human embryos, there is a serious ethical question to be addressed; should we be allowed to “design” humans to fit a preferred image?

For now, the answer to this question is no. Usage of CRISPR should be restricted to areas that are necessary or pose little risk to human life and society. Firstly, this technology could potentially create a two-tiered society of haves and have-nots. Children who have been genetically engineered to have certain advantages such as increased intelligence, athletic ability, etc., would have a distinct advantage in society over those who don’t. Though one may argue that these differences may already exist in society, this technology would essentially make the deciding factor who your parents are. Rich people would be able to pay the money needed to design their kids in a way that would make them more likely to succeed, which would in turn allow them to design their kids in the same way, and so on. Although things may not end up as they did in Red Rising, a book where the poor are the servants of a genetically superior upper class, a society in which the poor truly have little to no hope of rising to the top is possible.

Aside from these ethical concerns, many technical ones exist. Firstly, CRISPR does not work with 100% accuracy. Sometimes the enzyme cuts the wrong area of the DNA; this could obviously be problematic, particularly when used in a developing embryo. In addition, there is a risk that a poorly-designed guide mechanism may lead to the enzyme cutting the human genome when unintended. For instance, if someone put the enzymes responsible for the process in a virus and a person was exposed to this virus, a poorly designed guide which worked in humans could wreak havoc.

Second, there are unknown risks that come with editing DNA at the embryonic level. Potential effects could develop later in life which wouldn’t be discovered until this process had already happened to a portion of a generation. Unless we are absolutely certain of the long-term effects in humans, we shouldn’t risk using the technology in a manner which is far from necessary.

Overall, CRISPR is a promising technology for the field of genetic engineering, but it is not without its risks. History has shown us with crises such as antibiotic-resistance that quickly

#HollywoodSo White

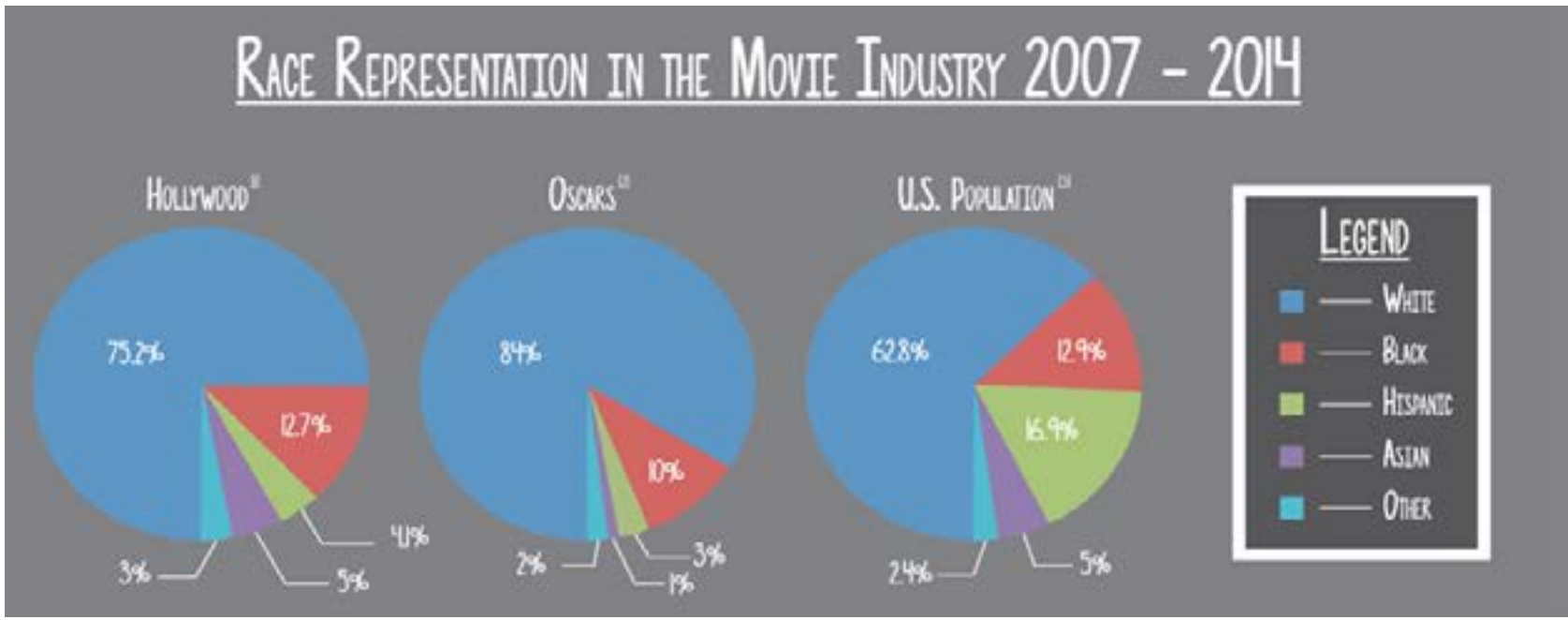


Illustration: Valiant Chan

OP-ED by CHARMAINE CHANG and MEGAN NIU

The Oscars is notorious for being super white. The whitest of the flock, with little to no representation of minorities. Straight Outta Compton, a 2016 blockbuster depicting the black community’s contribution to modern pop music, was represented in the Oscars by a single nomination for its writing. And even then, the writers were white. You would think that with the push for better minority representation in all aspects of society, there would be more coloured actors in major Hollywood films and more coloured Oscar nominees. But that’s not the case. For the second year in a row, the Oscars had only white nominees for lead and supporting roles. In protest, several famous actors and actresses boycotted the Oscars. Jada Pinkett Smith

wrote, “At the Oscars...people of colour are always welcomed to give out awards...even entertain, but we are rarely recognized for our artistic accomplishments.” In fact, this year’s Award Show host, Chris Rock, was a black comedian. He joked that the Oscars were the “white-people’s choice awards.”^[1] And he was completely justified in doing so. But at the same time, the underlying issue was not addressed. It is not only the Oscars that is a “white-people’s choice awards,” but Hollywood itself that greatly favours white people. The Oscars may be overwhelmingly white, but they should not shoulder all the hate. This problem is rooted in the makeup of Hollywood—in the film industry. The film industry is mostly white, especially the A-listers, and that affects the diversity of award nominees. We cannot shame the Academy for choosing the nominees that they have, as they may have indeed been decided on merit. Each film should be judged equally, and is that not what people want?

Between 2007 and 2014, the Academy and the film industry had grossly overrepresented white actors and the white population of U.S.A. But this is not new information. What is surprising, though, is that the representation of black actors has been inline with the U.S. population. The main issue, then, is that , the Oscars and the film industry have disproportion-

ately underrepresented Hispanics, Asians, and other ethnic minorities. This is even more odd considering that minorities are overrepresenting themselves when it comes to box office sales. In 2013, Hispanics purchased 25% of movie tickets sold, even though they are only 17% of the population.^[2] Did you know that 75% of Straight Outta Compton’s audience was non-Caucasian?^[3] It seems that the big-shots in Hollywood are missing out on a huge market by not giving representative speaking time to minorities.



It is widely agreed that the reason for the two-year whiteout is because of the constitution of the voting members of the Academy. Only 6% of the members are non-Caucasian—a very poor reflection the industry and the actors of top-grossing films.

On 22 January 2016, the Academy boldly declared that they are “going to lead and not wait for the industry to catch up,”^[4] by recruiting members that will represent the diversity desired. They have recognized that their current voting committee is made of 94% white members, while the actors of the 100 top-grossing films from 2007 to 2014 have only been 63% white. This is a great leap forward for the Academy. But in order for Hollywood to follow

suit, their top dogs will need to change too. Unfortunately, the directors, who are majority white, will not regulate themselves. For the most part, they have not been motivated to cast diverse sets of actors. There have been many cases where white people were cast to play other races in films, notably Johnny Depp as a Native American in The Lone Ranger and Angelina Jolie as an Afro-Chinese-Cuban character in A Mighty Heart. Plenty of times, white actors have played a character of a completely different ethnicity—even though there are capable actors of a matching ethnicity available. We can only hope that there will be initiative by directors to work towards proportional representation. But if there is no urge to be fair, the race composition of directors must change—just as how the Academy is diversifying. There have already been some small shifts — in 2011, 11% of directors were non-Caucasian and in 2013, that percentage rose to 17.8%.^[5]

Hollywood needs to right its wrongs. With its current direction, popular films reinforce centuries-old interracial dynamics. The Guardian has remarked that the role of coloured actors is usually to empower the lead actors, who are often Caucasian.^[6] This is not the reality today, so why should it be the reality of films set in the present day or an imaginary universe? Both the Oscars and Hollywood need to have a better representation of minorities. It is our concern as much as it is their concern. The industry is missing out on a demographic that wants to see someone physically relatable with a major speaking role. People want to see people of colour in films. Hollywood, it’s time to get with the program.

- [1] <http://www.telegraph.co.uk/culture/film/oscars/12175247/chris-rock-academy-awards-oscars-jokes-monologue.html>
- [2] <http://brandongaille.com/21-fantastic-moviegoer-demographics/>
- [3] <http://fortune.com/2015/09/08/straight-outta-compton-hit/>
- [4] <http://www.oscars.org/news/academy-takes-historic-action-increase-diversity>
- [5] <http://www.buncheecenter.ucla.edu/wp-content/uploads/2015/02/2015-Hollywood-Diversity-Report-2-25-15.pdf>
- [6] [http://www.theguardian.com/film/2016/jan/18/holly-](http://www.theguardian.com/film/2016/jan/18/hollywood)

ASK THE

Is it acceptable for a 17 (nearly 18) year old girl to date a 23 year old guy? Does it count as legal? -xPert

Love has no bounds (unless you want it to)! The situation you have described is perfectly fine as long as both parties are willing to accept it. Yes, the relationship is legal. In fact, the age of legal consent in Canada is 16, so no one else can judge you and say that the relationship is inappropriate or unacceptable. Ultimately, you are the one that should decide whether you are ready for such a relationship. As long as you’re not being pressured by the boy into do anything you aren’t comfortable with, then by all means go for it. On the other hand, the best choice could be to take it slow and wait a few years, given the tumultuous lifestyle of the average teenager. It’s really up to you to decide.

I'm a girl, and I really want to ask this guy out to prom. Is that a turn off/socially unacceptable? How do I ask him without sounding like a nervous wreck? -Prom gives me anxiety

A girl asking a guy to prom isn’t a turn off at all! In fact, he should be happy knowing someone actually took the time and effort to ask him out to prom. At the very least, he should at least be impressed with the courage you’ve mustered up. The toughest thing about prom is the act of asking, and he’ll be thankful he doesn’t have to go through that phase. Promposing is tough, but don’t let it get to you! To stay calm and cool throughout, just fake it ‘til you make it! If you act like you’re confident, you will begin to grow confident. Worst case scenario, he says no, but hey, it’s not the end of the world. At least you asked, and it’s better to find out now instead of wondering forever about whether or not he’d have say yes.

If you seek counsel from The Reckoner like the individuals above, send us a question at www.thereckoner.ca/ask-thereckoner

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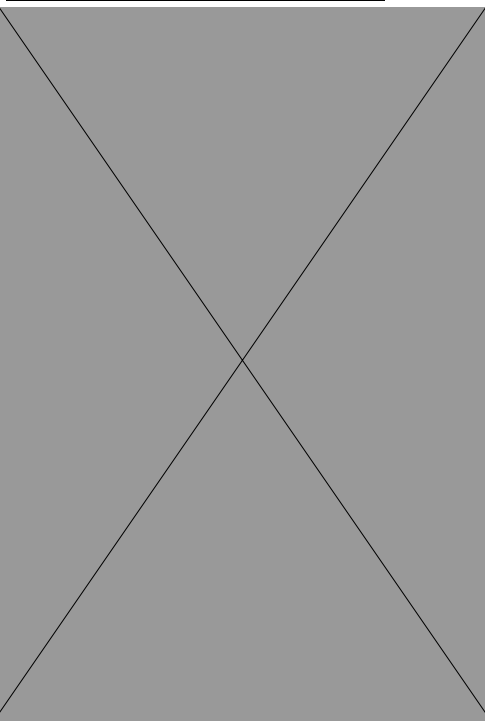
An Open Letter to Donald Trump:

Mr. Trump,

I try my hardest not to be political. I’ve refused to interview several of your fellow candidates. I didn’t want to risk any personal goodwill by appearing to take sides in a contentious election. I thought: ‘Maybe the timing is not right.’ But I realize now that there is no correct time to oppose violence and prejudice. The time is always now. Because along with millions of Americans, I’ve come to realize that opposing you is no longer a political decision. It is a moral one. I’ve watched you retweet racist images. I’ve watched you retweet racist lies. I’ve watched you take 48 hours to disavow white supremacy. I’ve watched you joyfully encourage violence, and promise to ‘pay the legal fees’ of those who commit violence on your behalf. I’ve watched you advocate the use of torture and the murder of terrorists’ families. I’ve watched you gleefully tell stories of executing Muslims with bullets dipped in pig blood. I’ve watched you compare refugees to ‘snakes,’ and claim that ‘Islam hates us.’ I am a journalist, Mr. Trump. And over the last two years I have conducted extensive interviews with hundreds of Muslims, chosen at random, on the streets of Iran, Iraq, and Pakistan. I’ve also interviewed hundreds of Syrian and Iraqi refugees across seven different countries. And I can confirm— the hateful one is you, those of us who have been paying attention will not allow you to rebrand yourself. You are not a ‘unifier.’ You are not a ‘presidential.’ You are not a ‘victim’ of the very anger that you’ve joyfully enflamed for months. You are a man who has encouraged prejudice and violence in the pursuit of personal power. And though your words will no doubt change over the

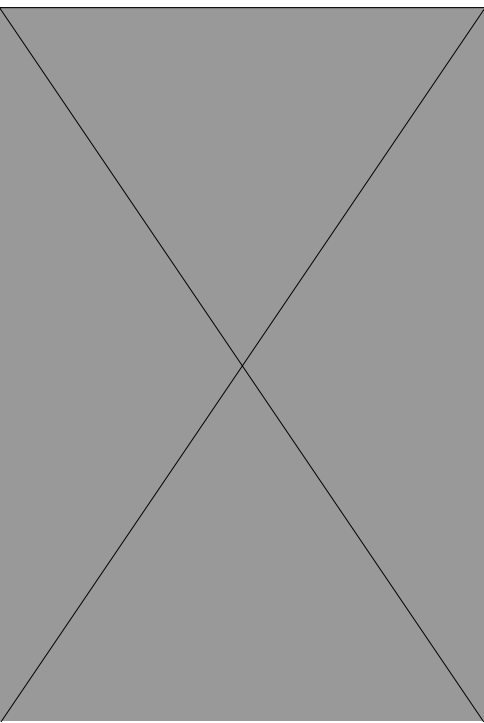
Photos by Cindy

For more Humans of Garneau, visit www.thereckoner.ca/category/hog

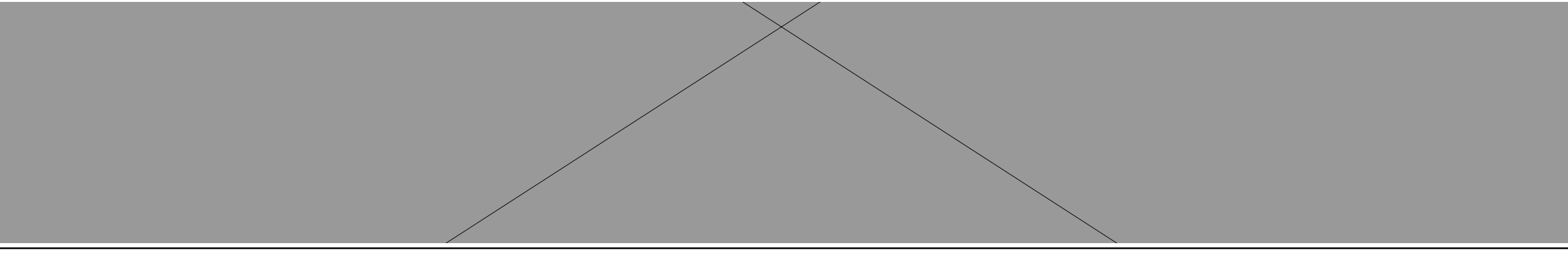


What do you want to do when you grow up? I want to become a lawyer—an immigration lawyer. I want to help bring immigrants, poor people, to Canada.

I love teaching. I teach a religious class on the weekends, and even at school, whoever needs help or whenever someone has a question, they come to me and I try my best to help them. Her friends added: “She’s patient. She’s a very affectionate teacher, trust me.”



Do you have a response to an article in this issue? Make your voice heard! Contact us at editorinchief@thereckoner.ca.



Art Gallery Girl

by MOUJAN SADERI

A painting of ballerinas
Standing tall and proud,
With pointed toes
And skirts made of clouds and
Her
Lying on the ground, on her back.
With one leg in the air
And hands above her head
Like a music box figurine.
Humming a song to herself
As she lay there
In the middle of the gallery floor.

She suddenly sprung up
And the image of her
In my mind
Floating and leaping across a studio floor
With pointed toes
And a skirt made of clouds
Floated away from me
As she did.

I could not help but follow.

I saw her standing in front of a painting.
People in the park,
On a Sunday.
Sitting and standing
In shadow and in light.
Ladies in long dresses,
Holding umbrellas as they walked,
And she was doing the same.
Her invisible umbrella in hand,
She walked with delicate steps,
Careful not to tread
On the long skirt
That would have been dragging along
The ground at her feet,
She pursed her lips
And held her chin high.

Watching her,
I could feel the warmth of the afternoon sun on my back.

And the lightness of a Sunday afternoon.

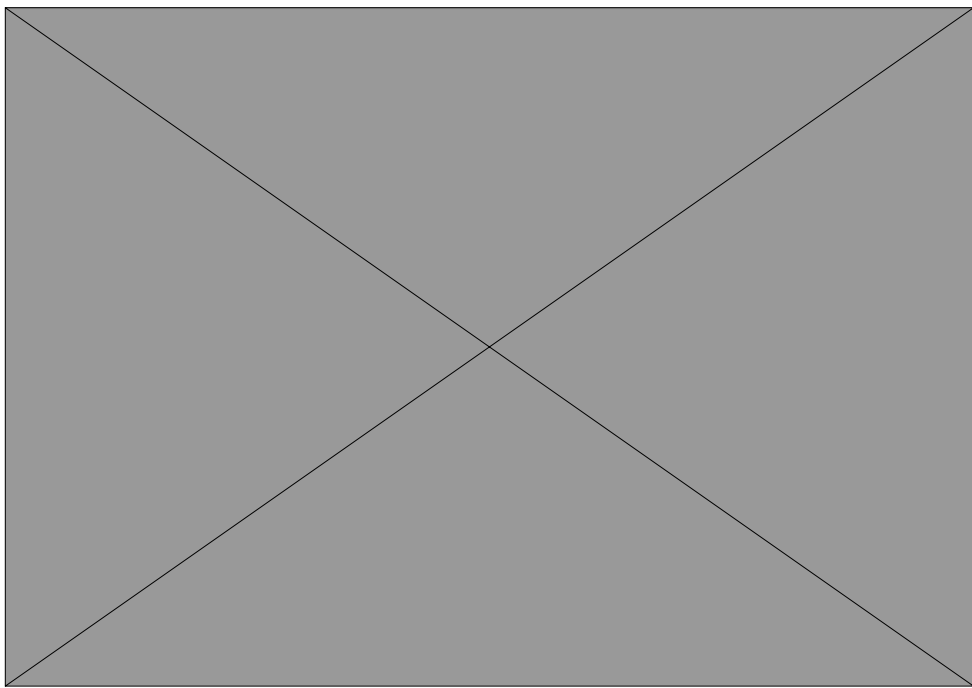
Before I knew it she had wandered away again.

I found her in front of a painted ship
On a stormy sea
Dark and gray
With large white sails fighting the cruel winds,
Looking impossibly helpless amid the waves.
She rocked slowly on her feet
—toe to heel to toe and back again—
And she began raising her arms,
With movements strong enough
To wear down the rock of jagged coastlines
Or knock me off my feet.

She walked towards the exit,
Dragging her fingertips along the wall.
As the door opened
And the sunlight shone through the doorway,
I expected the light
To go right through her.

She had given so much of herself to every painting,
every sculpture,
every sketch,
that there could not be anything left.

I thought she would disappear into the light,
dissolve until there was nothing left
But the feeling of pointed toes
And Sunday afternoons
And stormy air. ■



by GREATON TAN

Tim HORTONS

by AREEBA ASGHAR

Dear World,

As patriots of the home and native land, we would like to begin with a sorry, our national motto. Although the official paperwork are still pending, Bob (the one from Saskatchewan?) has got his moose running to discuss the matter with John (from Ontario?). A live broadcast from Justin Bieber had shut down the entire country for a week, but now there will be no further delays, eh.

This, it has come to our knowledge, is the way Canadians are perceived outside of our little bubble of snow. It may seem as if we are inhabitants of a different planet with the numerous stereotypes that have attached themselves to Canada. In fact, some have even approached us with these absurd ideas and demanded to know why we intoxicate ourselves with Tim Hortons coffee and ride bears to school. These false accusations have become slightly disturbing for us and a confrontation has become quite necessary. This letter is written to address common stereotypes about Canada, eliminating a false identity that represents our country.

One common misconception that is associated with Canada is the idea of a never ending winter. It is assumed that we live in igloos with polar bears and pet moose and temperatures that make Antarctica blush. Although Northern parts of the country see a habitual decrease in temperature, Canada's most populated regions do not experience a year round winter. All four seasons are enjoyed in Southern parts of the country. In fact, some summers witness so much heat, Canadians are seen praying for the cold.

Some believe that Canadians inhale, breathe, and die without Tim Hortons; our patriotism for the nation allows us to buy nothing but Canadian coffee. When asked, residents of the country will definitely not define drinking their coffee as a patriotic act. The abundance of Tim Horton shops on Canadian streets may be the only reason why we drink a little too much of their coffee. Although these shops are located on almost every step on our streets, other chains are also visible. Chains like Starbucks, Second Cup and many others are scattered around town and are a popular choice among many Canadians.

Our music, according to other nations, is composed entirely of Justin Bieber. His preppy songs play on repeat in our streets and one of them could even replace our national anthem. This, of course, is a false accusation that Canadians have heard one time too many. Canada has produced many renowned artists who have gained fame on an international level. Drake, whose popularity has reached the sky with youth all around the world, is a Canadian born artist. Bryan Adams, Celine Dion and many other Canadian stars have produced powerful ballads and gained worldwide recognition for their work.

On some occasions these unsuspecting nations approach us with such questions that we have to force our mouths to control that sigh and that head shake to pass as a friendly nod. 'Cause you know we are generally nice people. But some stereotypes, which exist indeed, have us rolling our eyes. There seem to be a widespread illusion that our population is

so small,we all know Bob from Brampton and John from Newfoundland. Canada, the second largest country in the world, has a population of 35 million people. Unless there seems to be a man who recognizes and remembers 35 million people, this is not true. We DO NOT know your great aunt Emma.

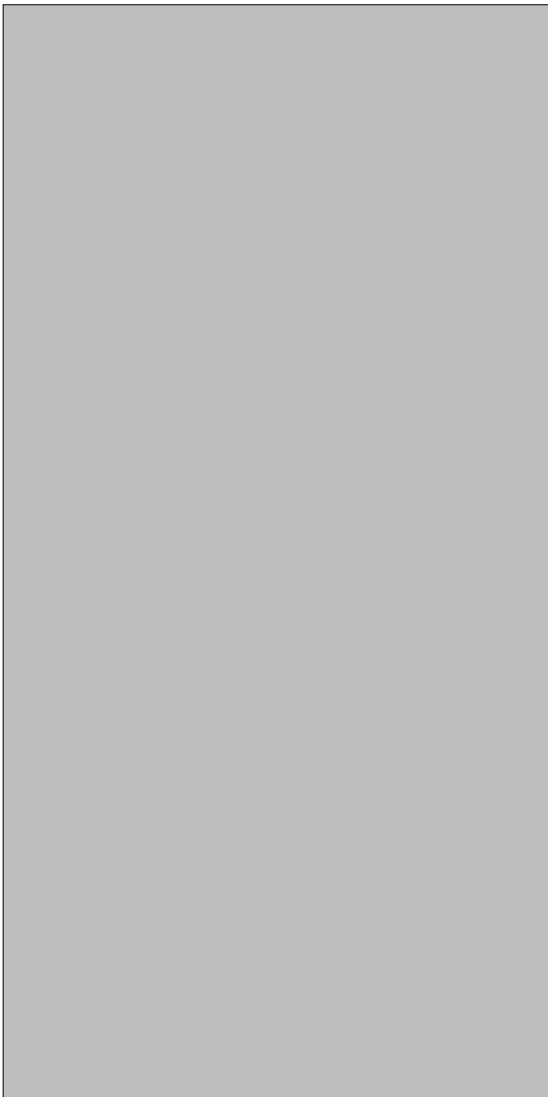
The usage of the word 'eh' is described with quite a lot of exaggeration when defining Canadian speech. Want to imitate Canadians? Simply add 'eh' to every single sentence you utter and you will fit right into the Canadian crowd. The only thing that you will achieve by doing such a thing is anger Canadians. Yes, we might throw in a couple of 'ehs' here and there in our conversation. We are, though, not inclined to use it to such an extent that no sentence can be completed without it. In fact, many Canadians do not EVER use 'eh' in their speech. Shock-er,right?

Ice hockey is the only known sport in Canada. This is a misconception that might anger some Canadians. Canada has, throughout its history, gained worldwide recognition for its ice hockey skills, but proclaiming that its the only sport we know is generally not the truth. We enjoy a variety of sports, watching and playing them like everyone else. It is not only winter sports that we know how to play either; basketball, baseball, soccer and all other types of sports are enjoyed by Canadians.

The standard Canadian politeness is one of the biggest stereotype that we hear about the home and native land. This, however, cannot be denied; we are generally real nice people. A lot of sorrys and thank yous can be expected in a Canadian conversation but some perceive this to be a sign of perpetual kindness that is unwavering. Of course that is not true. As humans, Canadians also experience rare bouts of anger and irritation. They are, however, only shown in the most extreme of situations.

So the next time you approach a Canadian, remember that we are quite sensitive about the absurd stereotypes that we are falsely accused of following. Please do not ask us about our abnormal caffeine intakes and never inquire about your friend Bob; we do not know him.

Thank you for your consideration.

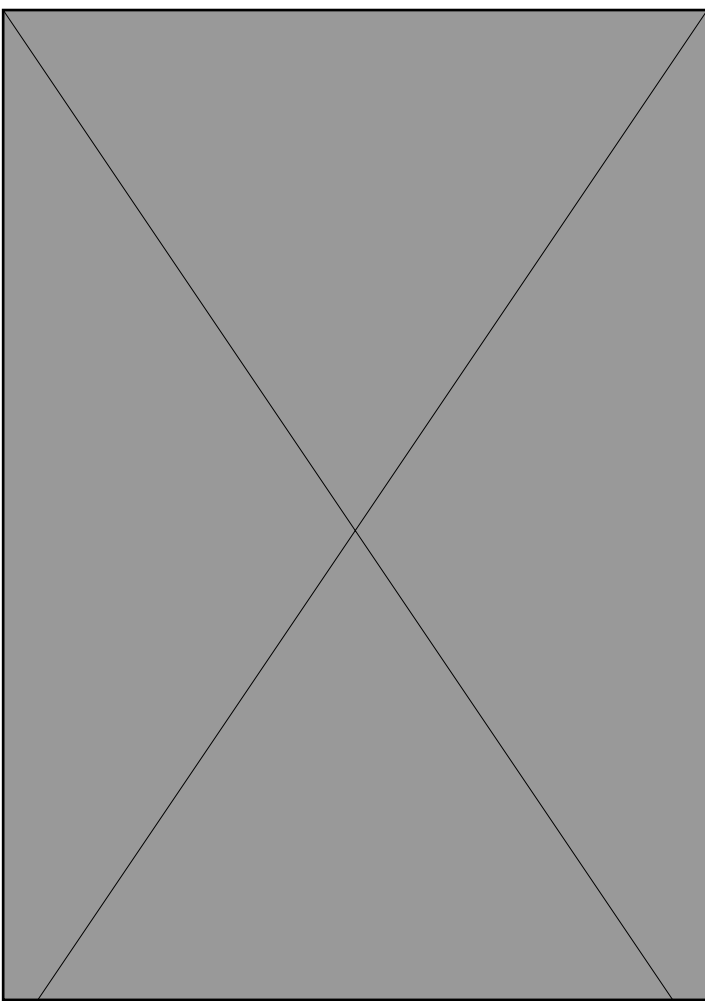
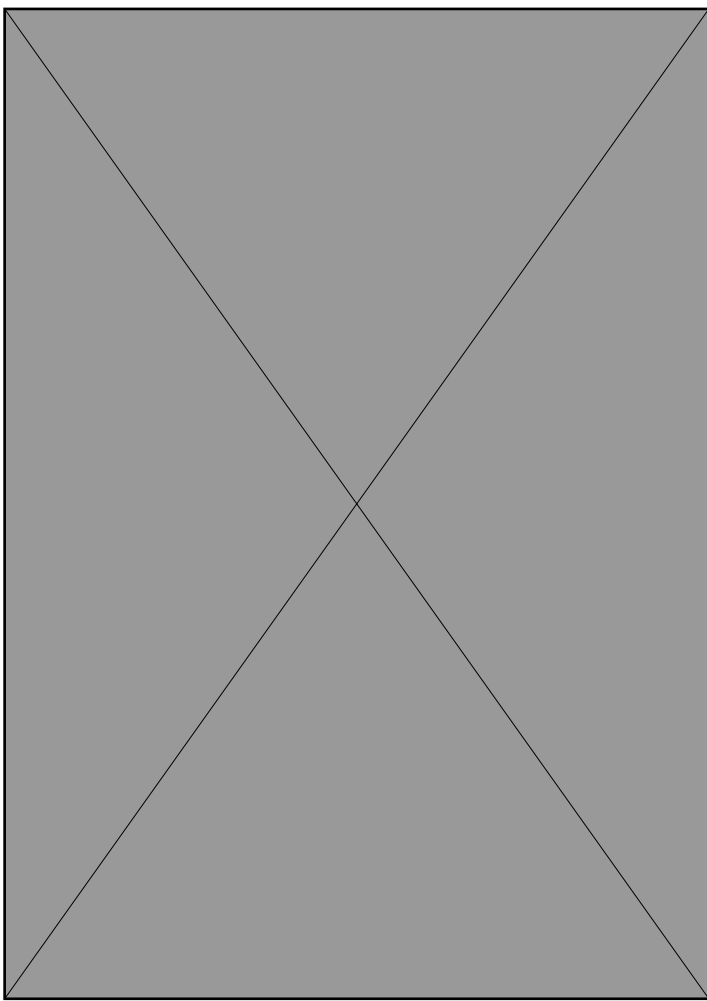


From,
Frustrated Canadians



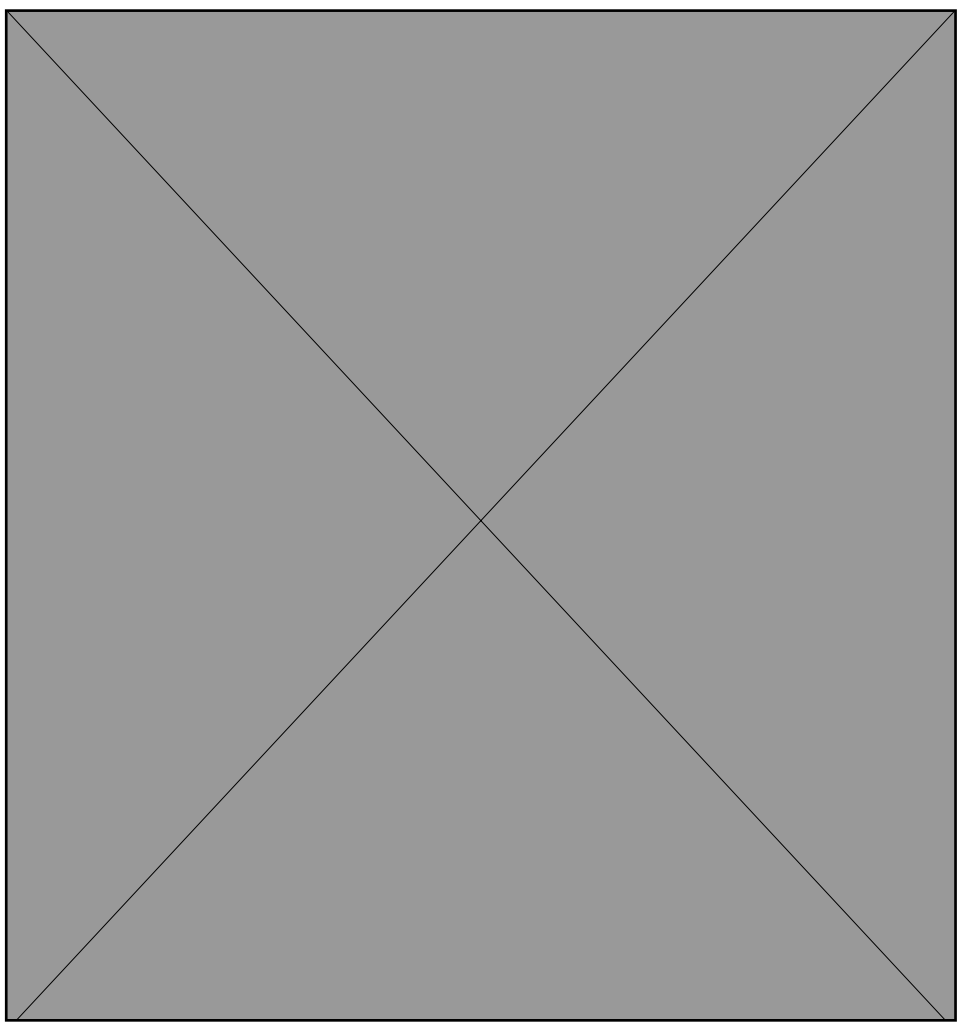
Oops 3 Hellen Li pieces

by HELLEN LI



Hellen Li Piece

by HELLEN LI



Idk what it's called

by KASHIFAH AHMED

A Whiff of the World

by VICTORIA YUAN

A weak smile flitted across her trembling lips. Such a small movement looked excruciatingly painful as she winced. It wasn't until now that I realize we take smiles for granted every day of our existences. I wonder if I'll ever see a real smile out of her again.

Her aged and quivering fingers grazed the edge of the paper. Her touch was as delicate as the fluttering of a butterfly's wing. A nostalgic pair of eyes gazed up at me.

Then she let her eyelids close with a seemingly expressionless face. I slowly reached for the photograph with a deep sense of dread and fear. Fear of reminiscence. Fear of facing the truth. Fear of feeling.

I was almost there. A fraction of a millimetre later and I'd feel the satisfyingly smooth surface of the photograph. A fraction of a millimetre later, and I'd

have to remember.

Finally I felt something touching my fingertip. A breath full of the most wonderful fragrances in the world overtook me.

Flowers of every kind. The kinds that are hesitant yet bloom beautifully during the springtime, the kinds that wilt away after a few ephemeral hours, the kinds that are so luscious and exotic that a hint of their pollen would cause violent sneezes.

Pastries from her favourite bakery. The aroma of warm buttery croissants and freshly-baked chewy cookies. The sickly smell of sweet sugar seemed to fill the room. The light scents of zesty orange peel and lemon curd left a nice undertone.

The tickling musk of old dust on a long-forgotten book from the shelf. The reassuring wafts of a full-bodied cof-

fee in the mornings of long days. The refreshing odour of the water during strolls along a winter shoreline.

I almost forget where I am and what I'm supposed to be doing. I look down and see her still in the exact same position and with her eyes closed. She looks melancholic.

"Grandma, I'll bring more photos tomorrow so we can look at them again."

The nod that she gives hardly constitutes as a nod. It could even be the slight dip of her head while breathing in and out. But I wouldn't have to ask to know that she would agree to my request.

"Grandma, don't worry. I'll give you a whiff of the world so you can remember... So you can remember how the world smells like." And with that, I gently slid the stack of photos out of her frail grip and took off. ■

